



[The IPCC's Sixth Assessment Report \(2022\)](#) finds that Africa has contributed the least to historical global greenhouse gas emissions (under 10%, according to the World Meteorological Organization- WMO) yet is already experiencing some of the world's most severe climate-related loss and damage, including reduced crop yields, water shortages and biodiversity loss. Climate change has reduced Africa's agricultural [productivity growth by 34% since 1961, more than any other region in the world](#). The WMO's [State of the Climate in Africa 2022 report](#) recorded over 110 million people directly affected by weather, climate and water-related hazards that year alone, causing more than US\$8.5 billion in economic damages and around 5,000 reported fatalities, 48% of them linked to drought and 43% to flooding. Without adaptation, aggregate damages from sea level rise and coastal extremes to just 12 major African coastal cities could reach US\$65–86.5 billion a year by 2050.

Uganda mirrors this disproportionate exposure. The [World Bank's Country Climate and Development Report](#) ranks Uganda the 14th most vulnerable country to climate change globally, yet only 163rd in readiness to address that risk, despite contributing an estimated 0.099% of global greenhouse gas emissions. Of the poorest Ugandan households already exposed to climate change, 80% report income loss from climate shocks, and the World Bank projects GDP could fall by up to 3.1% by 2050 without additional climate action. Over the past two decades, an average of roughly 200,000 Ugandans have been affected by climate-related disasters every year; floods alone impact close to 50,000 people and cost over US\$62 million annually, and in 2019–2020 natural disasters cost the country a combined US\$152.2 million, concentrated in the transport, housing and agriculture sectors¹.

These pressures connect directly back to water, sanitation and energy. The IPCC notes that 55–62% of the Sub-Saharan workforce is employed in agriculture and 95% of the region's cropland is rainfed, meaning livelihoods and food security are acutely exposed to the same droughts and floods that damage water infrastructure and disrupt safe water and sanitation services. At the same time, communities without access to clean, modern energy remain reliant on wood and charcoal for cooking, driving deforestation and local emissions while leaving households without the resilient power needed to cope with climate shocks. In this sense, closing Uganda's gaps in safe water and sanitation (SDG 6) and in affordable, clean energy (SDG 7) is

¹ See <https://www.preventionweb.net/publication/climate-risk-country-profile-uganda>

not separate from climate action (SDG 13), it is a form of it: climate-resilient water systems and clean, decentralized energy solutions such as solar mini-grids directly reduce emissions and strengthen the adaptive capacity of the communities most exposed to climate shocks.

For OEF, this makes climate action a cross-cutting commitment rather than a standalone programme area. OEF will design its water, sanitation and energy interventions to be climate-resilient from the outset, favouring low-carbon, locally appropriate technologies and infrastructure built to withstand droughts, floods and other climate shocks while supporting vulnerable communities to adapt to a changing climate. Through partnerships with communities, government, technical actors and funders, OEF will demonstrate practical, measurable and replicable solutions that contribute directly to its commitment to Access, Resilience and Impact.